

When I Say Ai-C, I'm Upset!

아이C 하면 아이고, 속상해!

Written by Jihye Ko · Illustrated by Woosung Oh

Chunchum Books · Korea · Hardcover

60 pages · 205 × 255 mm · 2026 · Ages 4–8

What is hiding behind “Ai-C”? · Look at the feeling before you scold the words



Kids spit out “Ai-C!” when they are angry, jealous, bored, or just done. Grown-ups hear a bad word and scold. The book starts one step earlier: that sound is not a swear. It is “ai” plus “sshi,” a grunt of not-wanting, and a whole weather system of feeling packed into one syllable.

Whenever Myeonghun says it, odd little creatures pop out of the air. At first they only scare him. Then he traces each one back—to a test he might fail, a prize a friend won, a classmate who moved away, a class that would not end, a flash of temper he already regrets. The question shifts from “Why did I say that?” to “What am I feeling right now?”

A fantasy picture book for children and the adults beside them. Feelings have no correct answer. Naming them, in words that actually fit, is how a child starts to share a heart.

SAMPLE INTERIORS



Jihye Ko · Author

Jihye Ko studied early-childhood education at Ewha Womans University and child and family studies at Yonsei University graduate school. She works as a picture-book editor-planner, writer, picture-book therapist, and reading guide, connecting books with children. Words, she says, are the bridge between people; she wrote the *In My Words* series hoping children will build that bridge firmly enough to keep using it as adults. Her books include *Pretend Play Is Fun!* and *I Can Do It Too!*.

Woosung Oh · Illustrator

Woosung Oh draws the twin characters Ore and Oo, and posts the four-panel strip *Pretty Decent Distractions* on social media. Books he illustrated include *The Dragon Is Money*, *The Jam Lid That Will Not, Will Not Open*, and *Elementary Hanja Vocabulary Daily Calendar*; books he wrote and drew include *How About Twins Like These?*, *Ore-Oo Find the Difference in Famous Paintings*, and *Ore-Oo and Fine Dust*. Instagram @OLAOO_WS.